

Examination of the Principles of Faith — Controversy VII: On the Succession of the Primacy of St. Peter

Adrian and Peter van Walenburch, Cologne 1647 — printed pp. 393, 412–413 (English translation)

A. Controversy VII — opening (printed 393)

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CONTROVERSY VII.

On the Succession of the Primacy of St. Peter.

I. It is asked. *Whether the Primacy of St. Peter passed to his successor?* — that is, whether his power was given by Christ so as to remain perpetually in the Church by way of ordinary jurisdiction. {marg. The state of the question.}

B. Controversy VII — nn. XLVII–L (printed 411–413)

Section XLVII begins on printed p. 412 (image v-21). Printed p. 411 (v-20) carries the end of XLIII and sections XLIV–XLVI; XLVI runs over onto the top of 412, where it ends with the words fidei petram [the rock of the faith] immediately before XLVII.

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XLVII. The Fifth General Council, of Constantinople [a] {marg. *a Tom.1. Conc. part.1.pag. 534.can.3.*}, *The Bishop of the city of Constantinople ought to have the honour of the primacy, after the Bishop of Rome, for the reason that it is New Rome.* See the Council of Sardica. *Can. 3. & 4.to. 1.conc. .part.1.pag.425.* E.F.

XLVIII. If, further, anyone should slander the Apostolic Chair, and call it a chair of pestilence, he is blameworthy together with the heretics, against whom St. Augustine wrote *contr. litter.Petil. lib. 2.cap.51.pag.108.* B.C.

NOTE.

XLIX. In the election of the Pontiff it is to be observed, that the designation of the person who is appointed to succeed the predecessor is not determined by Christ, but left to the Church; and that therefore now this, now that mode has been observed in the Church. But that the collation of the

power is from Christ, who by one act of will granted it to Peter and to all his legitimate successors, that is, to those legitimately designated: which will being posited, by a certain hypothetical necessity the dignity is communicated to the one duly elected. And thus the collation of power made to St. Peter perseveres, just as his dignity perseveres morally the same, though in different succeeding persons. [b] {marg. b Suar. *de tripl. virt. Theol. disp. 10. sect.4.n.3.*} And it is confirmed from *L. meminisse. 10. D. de offic. proconsul.leg.*, where it is said that there is one proconsulate, though successively there be many proconsuls: for so also one primacy was given to St. Peter, which remains one, though

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successively many hold the primacy. See *L. Proponebatur.76.ff.de iudicijs.*

L. Next, we believe by faith that this man, Innocent X, is the true Pontiff: for Christ revealed immediately that St. Peter and his successors are truly Pontiffs. And this revealed truth — that Innocent X is the true Pontiff — is sufficiently proposed to us when it is morally established that he has been accepted by the whole Church, and peacefully possesses his primacy: for the universal Church cannot err in a matter so grave. But concerning a matter proposed by the Church [the print reads simply *re*; see sic-note 18], there is in this no greater difficulty than when the Church proposes that these books are Canonical. But if anyone should wish to maintain that this is not to be believed by faith, but that moral certitude suffices: we are not contentious. See Jansenius's *Spongiam.cap. 44.pag.169.*

(Section L ends here; the next line on printed p. 413 is the display heading CONTROVERSIA VIII., not transcribed.)